

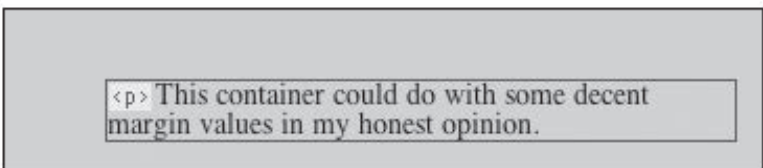
3.4 Padding

Padding is the distance between the edges (borders) of an HTML element and the content within it, and can be applied to any element. Both length and percentage values are available. But there is no auto value, and negative values cannot be declared for padding. Let's take the container div again and this time, add custom padding to each side:

```
/* Basic container */
#container {
width:300px;
margin-top: 20px;
margin-left: auto;
margin-right: auto;
margin-bottom: 1em;
border: 1px solid #000;
padding-top: 20px;
padding-left: 10%;
padding-right: 1em;
padding-bottom: 0;
background: #CCC;
}
```

Percentage in this case refers directly to the parent element's width. So if padding-left: 10% is declared, that equates to 10% of the parent element's given width. Using ems would also allow the padding to scale proportionately with the element. Such values come in very handy for liquid layouts.

The same shortcuts used for margin values are also available for padding.



The padding applied to the container positions the paragraph accordingly

As with the margin property, order is top (20px), right (1em), bottom (0), and left (10px).